

Europe study paths for Bangladeshi students, 2026–2027

Germany remains the most accessible and affordable European destination for Bangladeshi students in 2026, and Bangladesh is one of the few South Asian countries that does not require APS certification. That single exemption saves 3–4 weeks and roughly USD 250–300 (Studienkolleg) compared to Indian, Pakistani, Chinese, or Vietnamese applicants. (Visatocampus) The required blocked-account (Sperrkonto) amount is fixed at €11,904 (Germany Visa) for the 2026 and 2026/27 intakes (€992/month), (My German University) unchanged from 2025. (Expatrio) Full-ride options in Hungary, Sweden, France, and the Erasmus Mundus catalogue are all open now for 2026/27 entry, with concrete deadlines between November 2025 and February 2026. The window to act on Winter Semester 2026 German admissions (Uni-Assist deadline 15 July 2026) and February 2026 scholarship rounds is closing fast, so sequencing matters more than discovery.

Three shifts reshape the 2026 landscape: Norway now charges non-EU students roughly NOK 85,000–170,500/year, ending its free-tuition era; Finland still bills €8,000–18,000/year but mandates university scholarships; and Germany has tightened verification for Indian applicants (new 70% Class XII minimum from March 2026) (Studying in Germany) while leaving Bangladeshi pathways untouched. Below is the decision-ready synthesis.

Germany pathway: cheapest with the softest gatekeeping

Bangladeshi students apply **directly to German universities without APS**, a joint DAAD–Embassy verification system (AECC) that exists only for India, China, Vietnam, (uni-assist) Mongolia, and Pakistan. The German Embassy Dhaka confirms this explicitly: "the German embassy Dhaka does not use an APS office." (Diplo) Instead, the Embassy and universities verify Bengali-language certificates directly, usually through Ministry of Foreign Affairs attestation and certified German translations (cost roughly 3,000–8,000 BDT per document). (Studienkolleg) However, since **early January 2026 the Embassy Dhaka suspended routine legalization of Bangladeshi public documents** "until further notice" — verification now occurs only on administrative request from German authorities, (Diplo) which in practice means universities and the visa office handle checks during admissions and the visa interview.

Master's admission requires a recognised Bangladeshi bachelor's (BUET, (Studienkolleg) DU, and other H+ listed institutions qualify per the **anabin database**), (Studienkolleg) a typical **CGPA of 3.0/4.0**, IELTS 6.5+ (or TOEFL 80+), and an SOP. Technical universities (TU9 group — TUM, RWTH Aachen, KIT) often demand 3.2–3.3 (Opportunities Corners) and may recommend GRE. Students with CGPAs of 2.5–2.8 still secure admits at Hochschulen (Universities of Applied Sciences) and smaller-city public universities (Opportunities Corners) by compensating with strong SOPs, relevant coursework, and internships. (Walkinternational) **46 English-taught CS master's programs exist across 27 German universities**, (Expatrio) and public universities charge only a €150–350 semester fee.

Costs for 2026: €11,904 blocked account, (My German University) €75 visa fee, (Shiksha +2) private health insurance (€110–130/month), and total annual living budget around €11,000–13,000. The full journey from first German lesson to arrival takes **10–14 months and costs roughly 13–16 lakh BDT**. (Studienkolleg) Visa processing time after appointment is typically 4–8 weeks, (Studienkolleg) (Beyond German) though the Embassy warns waitlist times are currently unpredictable due to application surge. Student visa applications now run through VFS since 2 January 2025. (Diplo)

Scholarships worth applying to right now

The four programs below are fully-funded, open to Bangladeshi nationals for 2026/27 entry, and have distinct eligibility angles that make them complementary rather than competing. Apply to all you qualify for.

Scholarship	Deadline	Coverage	Key eligibility
Stipendium Hungaricum (Hungary)	15 Jan 2026, 2:00 PM CET (Graduates)	Full tuition + HUF 43,700/mo stipend + dorm + health insurance (Graduates)	BD citizen, (Graduates) no dual Hungarian citizenship; dual application via Tempus portal + MoE Bangladesh (Graduates)
Swedish Institute (SISGP)	SI portal: 9–25 Feb 2026; (Scholarshipsrank) (Scholarships Corner) university: 15 Jan 2026 (Scholarships Future +2)	Full tuition + SEK 12,000/mo + SEK 15,000 travel (Scholarshipsrank +2)	Minimum 3,000 hours work experience (Scholarship Roar) (SI) + leadership proof; (SI +3) ~1–2% acceptance (Scholarship Roar) (Scholarshipsrank)
Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters	Mostly Nov 2025–Mar 2026 (varies by consortium) (Scholarships Future)	Full tuition + ~€1,400/mo + travel + insurance (Bangladesh Post)	Bachelor's in relevant field; CGPA 2.5+ applicants have been selected; (Scholarships Future) apply to up to 3 programs (Applyindex +2)
France Excellence Eiffel	Campus France: 8 Jan 2026 (Scholars4Dev) (universities submit); (Campus France) student deadlines Nov 2025	€1,200/mo M1/M2 (Sciences Po) + transport + insurance (Campus France) (no tuition) (Sciences Po)	Max age 29 for Master's (born after 31 March 1996); (École normale supérieure d...) (ISIGK) university must nominate

Hungary's Stipendium program is the easiest fully-funded path for Bangladeshi students because of the **government-to-government cooperation** and the fact that the Ministry of Education in Dhaka nominates candidates (Graduates) before Hungarian universities assess them.

[Graduates](#) Timeline: entrance exams March–May 2026, results June–July, [Study Italy BD](#) visa August, arrival by 30 September 2026. [Graduates](#)

The **Swedish Institute scholarship** is selective but uniquely valuable for mid-career Bangladeshi applicants because the 3,000-hour work experience requirement ([SI](#)) screens out typical fresh-graduate competition. Bangladesh is explicitly named in the eligible-countries list.

[Scholarship Roar +4](#) Results are announced 23 April 2026. [Scholarships Corner](#) [Scholarships Future](#)

Erasmus Mundus is the most flexible because applicants can submit to three consortiums simultaneously. [Erasmusscholarships](#) High-relevance CS tracks for 2026–2028 cohorts include **EMAI (Artificial Intelligence)** ([lpcv](#)) with four universities including Pompeu Fabra and Radboud, [scholarships GPT](#) [Applyindex](#) **BDMA (Big Data Management and Analytics)** across ULB/UPC/TU Eindhoven/CentraleSupélec/Padua, [Applyindex +2](#) **SECCLO (cloud and information security)** based at Aalto, [Secclo +2](#) **IPCV (computer vision)** with a 9 March–7 April 2026 window, ([lpcv](#)) and **CyberMACS (applied cybersecurity)**. EMAI's tuition-fee-waiver round runs until 18 March 2026; [UPF](#) self-funded EU candidates have until 6 July 2026. [UPF](#) Crucially, prior Erasmus Mundus scholarship holders are ineligible, [Scholarships.af +2](#) and CGPAs as low as 2.5 have resulted in scholarship awards in past cohorts [Study International](#) [Scholarships Future](#) — **do not self-reject on grades.**

DAAD and the Germany scholarship ecosystem

DAAD runs **EPOS development-related scholarships** ([GreatYop](#)) and the **Helmut-Schmidt Programme** for Bangladeshi master's candidates, covering full living costs (€934+/month), [Scholars Avenue](#) tuition, travel, and insurance. The processing timeline is roughly **six months**, [My German University](#) so to start October 2026 you had to apply around August 2025 [My German University](#) — the 2026/27 DAAD intake cycle is largely closed now, but the 2027/28 cycle opens mid-2026 for applicants targeting October 2027 entry. DAAD-funded students are **exempt from the blocked account requirement** because the scholarship itself covers the €992/month minimum, [Diplo](#) [Beyond German](#) which is a material saving of €11,904 up front.

Beyond DAAD, the Deutschlandstipendium (€300/month, university-administered and merit-based) stacks with other aid, and the Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung and Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung political foundations fund social-science and policy master's students from developing countries.

Norway and Finland: no longer free, but still cheaper than anglophone destinations

Norway ended free tuition for non-EU/EEA students in autumn 2023. [IMFS](#) [Mastersportal](#) **NTNU now charges tuition fees**, [NTNU](#) though a proposed 2026 legal amendment may lower rates; [Visatocampus](#) Nord University expects to reduce its fees for 2026/27 pending that amendment. [Nord University](#) University of Oslo charges NOK 170,500/year for the European Studies master's and similar rates elsewhere — roughly **€14,500–15,000**. UDI requires proof of NOK 166,859 per

academic year in living costs ([Migrationvisportal](#)) on top of tuition. Norwegian universities offer **no scholarships covering tuition** ([NTNU](#)) (legally barred from using government grants for that purpose), though NTNU has a limited tuition-waiver scheme and UiO offers a small International Scholarship. Application windows for NTNU non-EU students: 1 November–1 December 2025 for August 2026 start. ([NTNU](#))

Finland charges non-EU students **€8,000–18,000/year** ([Apply Kite](#)) depending on institution, ([IMFS](#)) but all Finnish universities are legally required to offer scholarship programs. ([Mastersportal](#)) Aalto and Helsinki offer 50–100% tuition waivers ([Scholarships365](#)) based on academic merit; ([Blog +2](#)) at Helsinki, **GPA ≥ 3.8/5 earns a full waiver**, 3.4–3.7 earns 50%. ([University of Helsinki](#)) Aalto's 2026 master's application window runs 1 December 2025–2 January 2026, ([DAAD +3](#)) with results in April 2026 ([Euromagopportunities +2](#)) and tuition-fee deadline 9 July 2026. ([Aalto University](#)) ([Oulu University](#)) Oulu's Nokia Scholarship application opens 7–21 January 2026 ([Oulu University](#)) for SoC/RF-focused CS candidates. Living costs in Finland run roughly €900–1,000/month ([IMFS](#)) outside the capital region, ([Opportunities for Youth](#)) €1,200+ in Helsinki.

Timeline you cannot afford to miss

Work backwards from your intake target. **For Winter Semester 2026 Germany (October start), the Uni-Assist deadline is 15 July 2026**, ([Collegedunia](#)) meaning language tests and legalized documents must be ready by May and blocked account opened by June. For Hungary's September 2026 start, the 15 January 2026 Tempus deadline is absolute. For Erasmus Mundus, most tuition-fee-waiver rounds close between mid-February and mid-March 2026. For Sweden, the two-step process requires applying to programs by 15 January 2026 before the SI scholarship portal opens 9 February. ([SI](#)) ([Scholars4Dev](#))

A parallel application strategy — submitting to 2–3 German public universities + one Erasmus Mundus consortium + Stipendium Hungaricum + (if qualifying) SISGP — maximizes success odds at minimal incremental effort, because most of the documents (transcripts, SOP skeleton, IELTS, CV, recommendation letters) are reusable across applications.

Bottom line: Germany as anchor, scholarships as upside

For most Bangladeshi applicants targeting 2026/27, the rational base case is **direct admission to a tuition-free German public university with blocked-account financing**, treating the four fully-funded scholarships as high-value optionality rather than primary plans. Germany combines the shortest documentation pathway (no APS), the lowest confirmed cost of attendance in Europe, strong post-graduation rights (18-month job-seeking residence permit), ([Universität Passau](#)) and salaries of €45,000–50,000 starting for CS graduates. ([Expatrio](#)) Hungary is the softest fully-funded option; Erasmus Mundus delivers the strongest brand and mobility; Sweden rewards working professionals; France suits candidates under 29 with French-institution backing. The €11,904 blocked-account requirement is the binding financial

constraint for anyone without a scholarship — plan for that first, then layer scholarship applications on top.